



Yair Felig

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Four years at a VC-backed AI startup building conversational experiences for children aged 2.5–13. 1,200+ research sessions run directly — in daycares, homes, and a weekly in-house lab. Psychology and HCI research background (Reichman University, GPA 94; 2.5 years in an HCI research lab). Writes conversation logic, benchmarks AI safety, ships working learning products independently.

EXPERIENCE

UG Labs

May 2022 – 2026 · Tel Aviv

EdTech Product Research & Design · First Employee

- Before the product had a working AI, ran sessions manually as the character — scripting interactions, improvising responses in real time while the team observed. Translated the same interaction logic into the first JSON conversation trees when the product was built.
- Led 1,200+ research sessions with children ages 2.5–13: designed protocols, ran every session, and wrote structured insight reports that fed directly into product decisions.
- Built and ran a testing lab (2–3 sessions/week): developed new concept ideas, ran structured sessions, and wrote weekly insight reports for the product team over two years.
- Evaluated the platform against KORA (child AI safety benchmark, 8 risk categories, 3 age groups) and fed results into product requirements.
- Built a research data package covering 1,000+ child interaction sessions: structured dataset, interactive visualizations, methodology and PII documentation. Used in investor and partner conversations.
- Ran two large-scale US deployments: a solo field operation in Boise, Idaho (cold-contacted daycares and universities, hired a local team, 500 sessions in 6 months) and a 500+ session engagement with Applause, owning requirements, screening protocols, and delivery end-to-end.
- Designed and ran a public workshop teaching kids and parents to build AI experiences — built the site, ran promotion, facilitated live. Was picked up as an active product concept internally.
- For every EdTech sales conversation, built a working AI product tailored to that partner's specific curriculum and educational context — a sex education program, a Catholic school network with strict content constraints, a bilingual early literacy tool, a physics tutor, and others across the spectrum. Translated each partner's pedagogical language, subject matter, and constraints into a functional experience before the first call.

Israel Defense Forces — Paratroopers, 101st Brigade

2016 – 2022

Company Commander · Final rank: Major

- Commanded 160 soldiers from induction to combat readiness. Designed the training program, managed all scheduling and logistics, and owned every outcome for 6 years.

EDUCATION

Reichman University (IDC Herzliya)

2019 – 2022

B.Sc. Psychology — Human-Computer Interaction focus · GPA: 94

MILAB HCI Research Lab, 2.5 years — study design, experimental methodology, data analysis (junior → lead researcher) · Founded the Happiness Club — grew to 150+ members, largest student club at IDC · 3rd Place, All-Israel National Debate Championship

SKILLS

Research Methods

Study design, session facilitation, behavioral observation, synthesis

Field Operations

US deployment, consent workflows, quality management at scale

AI Product Design

Conversational AI flows, dialogue scripting, child safety benchmarking

Technical

React, FastAPI, REST APIs, AI APIs (ElevenLabs, OpenAI), Vercel

Data & Visualization

Structured datasets, Chart.js, research documentation

Languages

Hebrew (native) · English (fluent, US citizen)

ALSO

- Hashomer Hachadash — Shepherd. Responsible for 130 sheep and goats (age 18, before military service).
- HaGal Sheli (The Wave Project) — Facilitator, empowerment programs for trauma survivors, 2025.